

RUH Airport Status

DISRUPTED

As of 11:45 PM, Friday 9 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

166 flights cancelled on 9 October · last takeoff **11:42 PM** · last landing **11:38 PM**

Day total for 9 October; traffic has been moving since 9:38 PM.

HEADLINE

9 October totals: 166 flights cancelled at RUH and four halts of 45+ minutes, the longest 7:41 to 9:38 PM; traffic moving again since 9:38 PM.

There were 13 takeoffs in the last hour, the latest XY53 to Jeddah at 11:42 PM. The latest landing was F3236 from Madinah at 11:38 PM, with 8 landings in the last hour. 166 flights are cancelled on 9 October (72 departures, 94 arrivals) and 18 arrivals have diverted. **9 October in review:** RUH had halts of 45 minutes or more at 5:32 to 6:24 AM, 1:58 to 3:14 PM, 4:05 to 4:50 PM and 7:41 to 9:38 PM (no landing 7:41 to 9:45 PM), plus a shorter midday pause. The evening stop drove most of the day's diversions, mainly to Madinah and Qassim. GACA, via Al Arabiya, said three people were killed in two attacks on the airport; no official reason has been given for the evening stop.

166

FLIGHTS CANCELLED ON 9 OCTOBER

72 departures + 94 arrivals, 24% of 703 scheduled.

11:42 PM

LAST TAKEOFF

XY53 to Jeddah, 2 min before 11:45 PM.

11:38 PM

LAST LANDING

F3236 from Madinah, 7 min before 11:45 PM.

13

TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR

8 landings in the last hour.

18

ARRIVALS DIVERTED

Mostly to Madinah, Qassim, ISL.

Cancellation basis: Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:45 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 167 (72 departures, 21% 95 arrivals, 26%) at 11:45 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today	72 (21%)	95 (26%)	167	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled today, board count	72	94	166	FR24 boards, local day
Delayed today	236 (68%)	177 (49%)	413	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	24 (9%)	51 (22%)	75	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	60 min	88 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Disruption index (0–5)	5	5	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	216 of 345	192 of 352	408 of 697	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	18	18	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled for 10 October	32	38	70	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	167	168	335	FR24 stats panel

CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia

18

Qatar Airways

14

Turkish Airlines

11

flyadeal

9

flynas

9

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Istanbul

16

Dubai

14

Doha

14

Dammam

12

Cairo

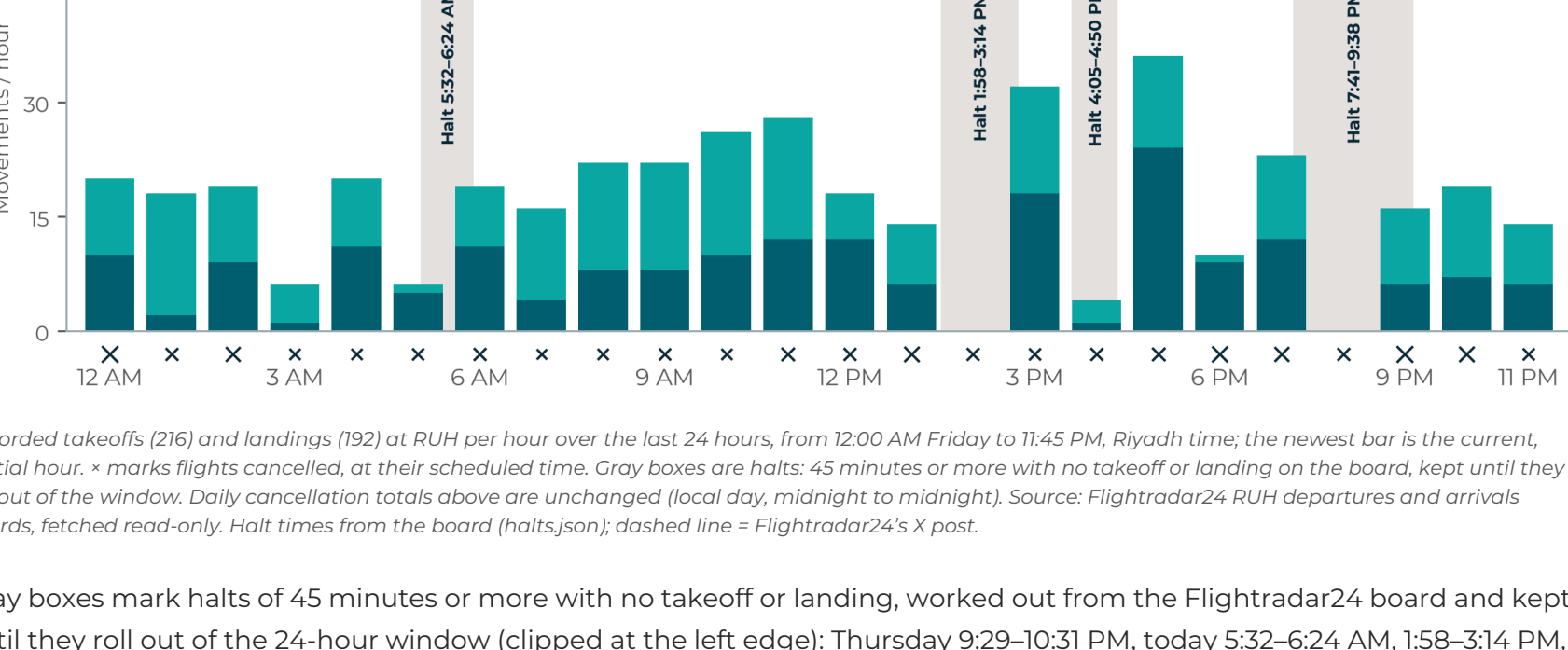
9

Source: Flightradar24 public airport data (airport.json details/stats panel, fetched 11:45 PM; departures and arrivals boards, fetched 11:45 PM). Rankings count both directions from the board for today. The stats panel and the board count slightly differently, so a few flights' difference is expected. Outbound diversions are not shown on the RUH board.

AIRPORT FLOW, LAST 24 HOURS

1

Takeoffs and landings per hour, last 24 hours to 11:45 PM.



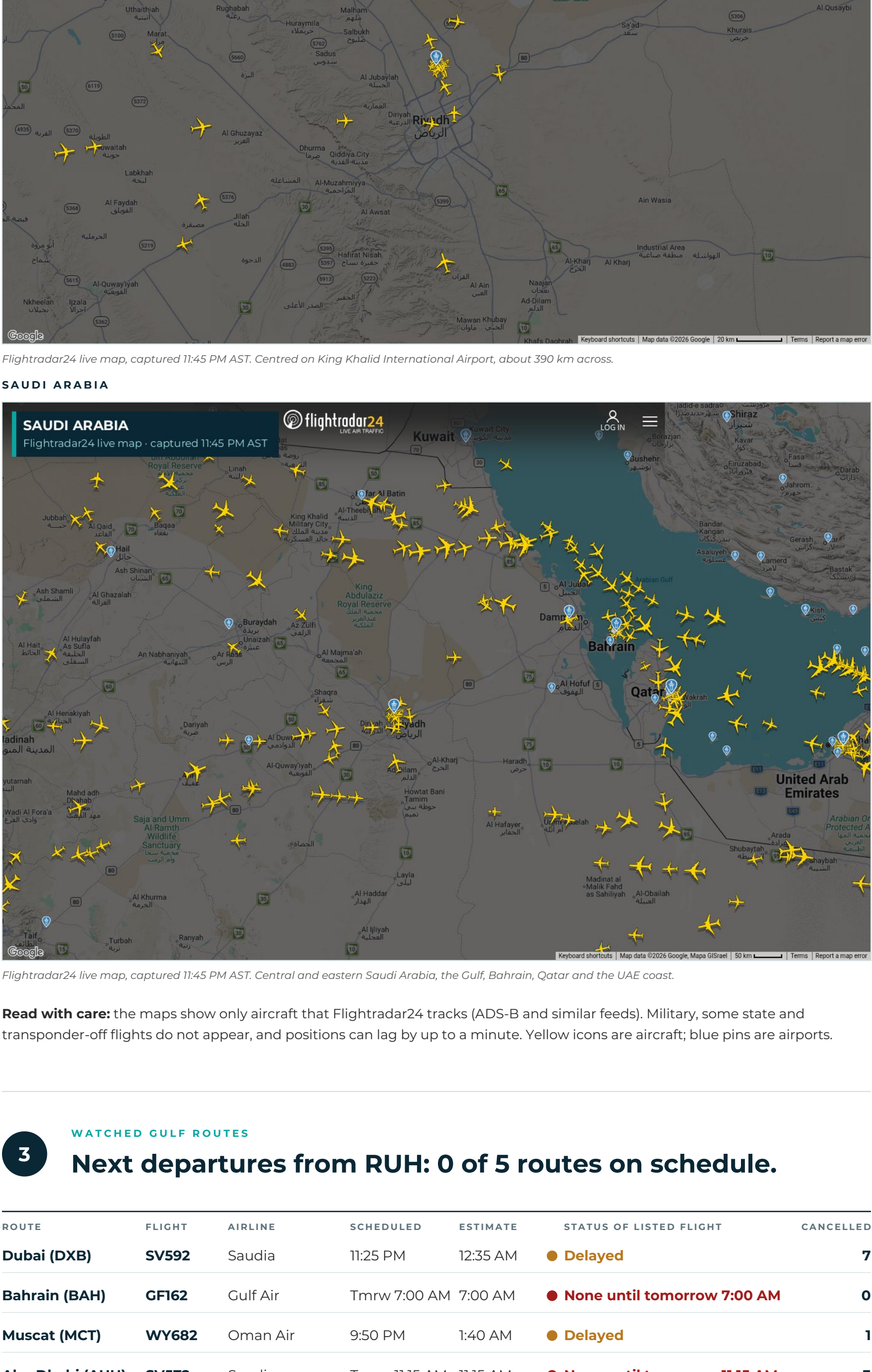
Recorded takeoffs (216) and landings (192) at RUH per hour over the last 24 hours, from 12:00 AM Friday to 11:45 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. ✕ marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Daily cancellation totals above are unchanged (local day, midnight to midnight). Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only. Halt times from the board (halts.json); dashed line = Flightradar24's X post.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window (clipped at the left edge): Thursday 9:29–10:31 PM, today 5:32–6:24 AM, 1:58–3:14 PM, 4:05–4:50 PM, and 7:41–9:38 PM (no takeoff 7:24–9:38 PM, no landing 7:41–9:45 PM). Today's midday pause (no takeoff 12:29–1:21 PM, no landing 12:44–1:32 PM) was below the 45-minute mark, so it has no gray box.

AIRSPACE NOW

2

Live traffic picture over Riyadh and the region.



Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:45 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across.

Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:45 PM AST. Central and eastern Saudi Arabia, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast.

Read with care: the maps show only aircraft that Flightradar24 tracks (ADS-B and similar feeds). Military, some state and transponder-off flights do not appear, and positions can lag by up to a minute. Yellow icons are aircraft; blue pins are airports.

WATCHED GULF ROUTES

3

Next departures from RUH: 0 of 5 routes on schedule.

ROUTE	FLIGHT	AIRLINE	SCHEDULED	ESTIMATE	STATUS OF LISTED FLIGHT	CANCELLED
Dubai (DXB)	SV592	Saudia	11:25 PM	12:35 AM	Delayed	7
Bahrain (BAH)	GF162	Gulf Air	Tmrw 7:00 AM	7:00 AM	None until tomorrow 7:00 AM	0
Muscat (MCT)	WY682	Oman Air	9:50 PM	1:40 AM	Delayed	1
Abu Dhabi (AUH)	SV572	Saudia	Tmrw 11:15 AM	11:15 AM	None until tomorrow 11:15 AM	3
Doha (DOH)	QR8731	Qatar Airways	Tmrw 11:45 AM	—	None until tomorrow 11:45 AM	7

Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures board, fetched 11:45 PM. Cancelled = today's cancelled departures on the route. Status describes the listed flight: itself on schedule = no later estimate; delayed = estimate 15+ minutes after schedule. Dubai includes DXB only. Riyadh Air RX243 to Dubai, due 3:50 PM, finally left at 9:50 PM. Cancelled today include Emirates EK816, EK820, EK818, flydubai FZ848, FZ842, FZ856 and flynas XY217 to Dubai; Qatar Airways QR1167, QR1171, QR12141, QR1169, QR1165, QR1239 and QR1173 to Doha; Ethiad EY552, EY556 and EY560 to Abu Dhabi; SalamAir OV206 to Muscat.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

4

Traffic resumes after the 7:41 to 9:45 PM stop with no official reason; Mauritania and the UN envoy condemn the airport attacks.

Checked at 11:29 PM: Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CORROBORATED UAE condemns the Houthi attacks on King Khalid airport and a Saudia aircraft, which killed three Saudis
[Al Arabiya English on X](#) · 10:44 PM · published 10:44 PM; last checked 11:29 PM

The UAE Foreign Ministry condemned the Houthi attacks on King Khalid International Airport and a Saudia aircraft, which killed three Saudis, calling them a blatant violation of Saudi sovereignty. Al Ekhbariya also reported the condemnation at 10:38 PM (<https://x.com/alekhbariyaNews/status/2108643190026932411>). No operational information.

CONFIRMED UN envoy for Yemen and Mauritania condemn the Houthi attacks on King Khalid and Abha airports
[SPA English on X](#) · 10:18 PM · published 10:18 PM; last checked 10:35 PM

SPA reports Mauritania condemned the attacks targeting King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh and Abha International Airport. At 10:12 PM Al Ekhbariya reported the UN special envoy for Yemen also condemned the attacks on both airports (<https://x.com/alekhbariyaNews/status/2108636663836803288>). Neither gives an operational reason for the evening halt.

CORROBORATED Flightradar24: many flights diverting to alternate airfields, then flights now making their way toward Riyadh
[Flightradar24 on X](#) · 9:31 PM · posts 8:50, 9:20 and 9:31 PM; last checked 9:33 PM

At 9:20 PM Flightradar24 posted that many flights were diverting to alternate airfields (<https://x.com/flightradar24/status/2108623703919763526>); at 9:31 PM it said flights are now making their way toward Riyadh. At 8:50 PM it noted the last landing was over an hour ago (<https://x.com/flightradar24/status/2108616180432814231>). The board matches: 9 diversions during the stop, no landing yet after 7:41 PM.

UNVERIFIED teleSUR says Houthi spokesman Saree claimed a ballistic missile attack on Riyadh airport; no matching Saree post found
[teleSUR English on X](#) · 9:00 PM · published 9:00 PM; last checked 9:11 PM

teleSUR English reports that Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree claimed a ballistic missile attack on King Khalid International Airport. We found no matching post on Saree's own account. The Ministry of Defense, SPA and Reuters had said nothing as of 9:11 PM.

CONFIRMED France and Syria condemn the Houthi attacks; Syria names King Khalid airport
[Al Ekhbariya on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 8:39 PM · published 8:39 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Saudi state TV Al Ekhbariya reports France condemned the Houthi attacks on civilian sites in the Kingdom and expressed solidarity. At 8:22 PM it reported Syria condemned the attacks on King Khalid International Airport (<https://x.com/alekhbariyaNews/status/2108609076263354737>). Neither gives operational information.

UNVERIFIED Posts call this Riyadh's fifth closure today
[Social accounts on X](#) · 8:31 PM · published 8:36 PM; last checked 9:33 PM

A user post says Riyadh closed for the fifth time today and aircraft are holding, with some diverting low on fuel. Our board-based count shows this is the fourth halt of 45+ minutes today (5:32 AM, 1:58 PM, 4:05 PM, 7:41 PM).

UNVERIFIED Posts report explosions or sirens in Riyadh from 8:18 to 8:44 PM, and aircraft holding; no official confirmation
[Social accounts on X](#) · 8:31 PM · 8:18 to 8:44 PM; last checked 9:11 PM

Several social accounts reported explosions or sirens in Riyadh between about 8:18 and 8:44 PM, and air traffic holding near the city (e.g. <https://x.com/PeterVogel/status/2108609212096094356>). No official confirmation.

CLAIM Houthi spokesman claims Saudi jets carried out 77 air and missile strikes in Yemen in 24 hours
[Yahya Saree on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 8:26 PM · published 8:26 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree claimed Saudi warplanes carried out 77 air strikes and missile attacks on Sanaa and several provinces in the past 24 hours, using aircraft from Khamis Mushait and Taif. This is a Houthi claim, not independently confirmed; it says nothing about RUH.

CONFIRMED Civil Defense warns against filming or sharing interception or debris sites; no shelter order
[Saudi Civil Defense on X](#) · 8:11 PM · published 8:11 PM; last checked 9:11 PM

Saudi Civil Defense warned the public not to film or share interception or debris sites. It did not issue a shelter order.

SUPERSEDED Superseded: GACA (via Al Arabiya) said three were killed in two attacks and operations had returned to normal; traffic stopped again at 7:41 PM
[Al Arabiya English on X](#) · 7:20 PM · published 7:20 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Al Arabiya English reports, citing the General Authority of Civil Aviation (GACA), that three people were killed in two attacks on Riyadh airport and that operations have returned to normal. BasNews English (8:10 PM, <https://x.com/EnglishBasNews/status/2108605958532268527>) also cites GACA for the three deaths and says one of the two attacks hit a Saudia aircraft; only Al Arabiya carries the 'back to normal' line. We have not found the GACA statement itself.

CONFIRMED Saudi UN envoy: the Houthis targeted Riyadh airport in a blatant terrorist attack and threaten civil aviation
[Arab News on X](#) · 6:59 PM · published 6:59 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

At the UN Security Council, Saudi Arabia's envoy Abdulaziz Alwaisi said the Houthi militia targeted Riyadh airport in a blatant terrorist attack, that its attacks wounded civilians including women and children, and (per Al Ekhbariya) that it threatens civil aviation security.

CONFIRMED Al Ekhbariya: plans and preparations helped operations resume at King Khalid airport
[Al Ekhbariya on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 6:45 PM · published 6:45 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Saudi state TV Al Ekhbariya's correspondent said plans and preparations helped operations resume at King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh.

CONFIRMED The United States condemns Houthi attacks on civilian infrastructure and airports in Saudi Arabia; the UK also backs the Kingdom
[Al Ekhbariya on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 6:12 PM · published 6:12 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Saudi state TV Al Ekhbariya reports the United States condemned the Houthi attacks on civilian infrastructure and airports in the Kingdom and said it stands firmly with Saudi Arabia. At 6:09 PM it reported Britain also stands with the Kingdom and affirms its right to defend itself. Neither statement gives operational information.

CONFIRMED Riyadh Airports tells passengers to check flight status with their airline
[Riyadh Airports on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 6:05 PM · published 6:05 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Replying to a passenger, the official Riyadh Airports airport asked travellers to contact their airline to confirm flight status and get updates. It gave no reason for this afternoon's stoppage.

CONFIRMED Houthi spokesman Yahya Saree says 'humanitarian flights' to and from Riyadh airport need a permit from Sanaa
[Yahya Saree on X \(Arabic\)](#) · 3:51 PM · published 3:51 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree posted that humanitarian flights to and from Riyadh airport will be allowed if they hold a permit from the humanitarian operations coordination centre in Sanaa. This confirms the statement was made, not that it has any effect on flights. The Houthis made no attack claim for Riyadh today.

CONFIRMED Flightradar24: Riyadh airport 'open again'
[Flightradar24 on X](#) · 3:18 PM · published 3:18 PM; last checked 8:45 PM

Flightradar24 posted that Riyadh airport was open again, four minutes after the first departure following the halt (Fly Jinnah 9P581 at 3:14 PM on the board). The cause of the 1:58 to 3:14 PM halt is UNCONFIRMED: GACA, KKIASA and Saudia have made no statement. A precautionary closure is likely but not confirmed.

CONFIRMED Flightradar24: Riyadh airport 'closed again', no flights for an hour
[Flightradar24 on X](#) · 2:58 PM · published 2:58 PM; last checked 8:45 PM; widely re-shared since, still no official reason as of 3:31 PM

Flightradar24 posted that Riyadh airport was closed again, with no landings or takeoffs in the past hour, and put today's cancellations at 124, matching our board count. The cause is UNCONFIRMED: GACA, KKIASA and Saudia have made no statement. A precautionary closure is likely but not confirmed.

UNVERIFIED Social accounts report missile launches toward Riyadh and explosions around 2:05 PM; no official confirmation
[Interceptor News on X](#) · 2:09 PM · published 2:09 PM; last checked 8:45 PM; similar post 2:34 PM (<https://x.com/dan916/status/2108521397412679740>)

Several social accounts reported missile and drone launches from Yemen toward Riyadh at about 2:05 PM and explosions heard in the city, saying operations at King Khalid airport were suspended. GACA, Riyadh Airports and Saudia have not commented. The Flightradar24 board showed no movement from 1:58 to 3:14 PM (see section 1).

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What the numbers are, and are not.

- Board figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, Gulf routes, chart) come from the Flightradar24 RUH boards fetched, at 11:45 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or Riyadh Airport source, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.

- The headline cancellation figure is the board count; Flightradar24's stats panel lags it by a few flights. Delayed, on-time, average-delay and index figures are the panel's own.

- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
11:45 PM, Fri 9 Oct	11:45 PM	Flightradar24, Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA, GACA	Disrupted	Open sources · not official	1:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24 (boards, airport stats, X), Reuters, AP, Arab News, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 1:00 AM